

6.4 Tool & Equipment Log

What tools are on site, who owns them, what condition they are in — and when rentals are due back.

PURPOSE: Tools and equipment represent a significant investment and theft risk on construction sites. This log helps you track what tools are on site, who owns them, and their condition. For rental equipment, it helps you manage costs by tracking rental periods and ensuring timely returns.

Instructions

- Log all tools brought to the site, whether yours, borrowed, or rented
- Record serial numbers for valuable tools — essential for theft claims
- Note when tools are removed from site to avoid disputes about missing items
- For rentals, track start and return dates carefully to avoid extra charges
- Document tool condition to avoid liability for existing damage
- Update this log weekly at minimum, or whenever tools arrive/leave

IMPORTANT — Tool Theft Prevention

Construction tool theft is extremely common. Lock up tools every night, mark valuable tools with your name or ID, photograph expensive equipment, and consider tool insurance. Document serial numbers for all power tools — you'll need them for police reports and insurance claims.

TOOLS ON SITE

List all tools currently on your job site. Include power tools, hand tools, ladders, scaffolding, etc. Update when tools come and go.

Tool Register

Tool Description	Brand / Model	Serial Number	Owner	Date Brought to Site	Date Removed	Condition	Value
			☐ Mine ☐ Borrowed ☐ Rental			☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Poor	
			☐ Mine ☐ Borrowed ☐ Rental			☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Poor	
			☐ Mine ☐ Borrowed ☐ Rental			☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Poor	
			☐ Mine ☐ Borrowed ☐ Rental			☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Poor	
			☐ Mine ☐ Borrowed ☐ Rental			☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Poor	
			☐ Mine ☐ Borrowed ☐ Rental			☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Poor	
			☐ Mine ☐ Borrowed ☐ Rental			☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Poor	
			☐ Mine ☐ Borrowed ☐ Rental			☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Poor	

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			☐ Mine ☐ Borrowed ☐ Rental			☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Poor	

BORROWED TOOLS

Keep detailed records of borrowed tools to ensure they're returned in good condition and disputes don't damage relationships.

Borrowed Tool Register

Tool Description	Borrowed From (Name)	Contact Info	Date Borrowed	Condition When Borrowed	Date Returned	Condition When Returned	Returned
							☐
							☐
							☐

Borrowed Tool Register

Tool Description	Borrowed From (Name)	Contact Info	Date Borrowed	Condition When Borrowed	Date Returned	Condition When Returned	Returned
							☐
							☐
							☐
							☐
							☐

RENTAL EQUIPMENT LOG

Track rental equipment carefully. Late returns can result in expensive extra charges. Rental companies charge by the day, week, or month — know your rental terms and plan accordingly.

Rental Register

Equipment Type	Rental Company	Rental Agreement #	Start Date	Rental Rate	Due Back Date	Actual Return Date	Late Fees (if any)	Total Cost
				☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly \$ _____				

Rental Register

Equipment Type	Rental Company	Rental Agreement #	Start Date	Rental Rate	Due Back Date	Actual Return Date	Late Fees (if any)	Total Cost
				☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly \$ _____				
				☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly \$ _____				
				☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly \$ _____				
				☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly \$ _____				
				☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly \$ _____				
TOTAL RENTAL EQUIPMENT COSTS:								\$

RENTAL EQUIPMENT NOTES

Rental Details & Issues

Equipment: Rental Agreement #:

Condition at Pickup

Condition at Return

Any Damage Charges: Yes No

Amount: \$ Description:

Rental Details & Issues

Equipment: _____ Rental Agreement #: _____

Condition at Pickup

Condition at Return

Any Damage Charges: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Amount: \$ _____ Description: _____

Rental Cost Saving Tips

- Understand rental periods — daily, 4-hour, weekly, monthly rates vary significantly
- Weekend rates are often cheaper — plan equipment use for Friday-Monday
- Return equipment as early as possible on the due date to avoid extra charges
- Inspect equipment carefully before leaving the rental yard — document existing damage
- Keep gas receipts if required to refuel equipment
- Consider buying vs. renting for tools you'll need throughout the project
- Compare prices between rental companies — rates vary widely